

specific they are, the better chance you may have of receiving them. Trust me, there are some obscure scholarships out there. In a brief internet search, I found scholarships exclusively for tall people, for people who practice the art of duck calling, and for people who plan to pursue “potato-related areas of graduate study.”¹⁴ So find your niche, and apply for that free money.

Federal Work-Study

Federal Work-Study is a program that provides part-time jobs to students with financial need, helping them earn money and pay for their college expenses. Don’t get too excited—these are not jobs that are going to make you rich, but they do help you put some extra money in your pocket while you are a broke college student. You will usually work on campus and your part-time hours are going to be set by the financial aid office. While I was in college, I had jobs in the student center, in the school bookstore, and even as an assistant for an eccentric art professor. These jobs will pay you at least minimum wage.

Student Loans

Student loans are a very common way—and the scariest way—to help pay for the cost of college. Student loans are money given to you by the federal government or a private lender that you need to pay back with interest. The reason these loans can

14 “Scholarship Finder,” CareerOneStop, U.S. Department of Labor, Employment and Training Administration, accessed November 20, 2020, <https://www.careerone-stop.org/toolkit/training/find-scholarships.aspx>.